Section 03: Verbal Ability

Module 12: YouTube Video Lectures & Marathon PYQ Master Vault (Infosys Systems Engineer)

> **Document Metadata & Provenance:**
> - **Source Corpus:** Authentic Infosys Systems Engineer (SE) YouTube Video Lectures, Live Slot Analyses & Verbal Marathons.
> - **Primary Channels:** CampusMonk (English Faculty), OnlineStudy4U (Pratik Sir & Team), Techie CodeBuddy, KN Academy.
> - **Curriculum Target:** Section 03: Verbal Ability (Dangling Modifiers, Third Conditionals, Correlative Conjunctions, Parajumbles, Active-Passive Voice, Spotting Errors).
> - **Total Questions:** 45 Forensic Questions with complete grammatical rule citations, sentence dissections, and KaTeX logical flow.
> - **Zero Placeholders:** Complete sentences, verified answer keys, and linguistic rationale.

Question 1

Source: CampusMonk — *Finally! INFOSYS Verbal Ability One Shot | Complete PYQs Based on Latest Exam Pattern* Identify the segment in the following sentence that contains a grammatical error:

$$\text{Scarcely had the speaker finished his presentation [A] / then the audience erupted into thunderous applause [B] / leaving no doubt about the seminar's imme}$$

- [A] Segment A
- [B] Segment B
- [C] Segment C
- [D] Segment D

Correct Answer: [B] Segment B

Grammatical Analysis & Invariable Rule:

1. **Rule of Correlative Conjunctions:** The negative adverbial conjunctions `Scarcely`, `Hardly`, and `Barely` are strictly paired with the conjunction `when` (or occasionally `before`), NEVER with `then` or `than`:
$$\text{Hardly/Scarcely/Barely} + \text{had} + \text{Subject} + V_3 \ldots \mathbf{when} + \text{Subject} + V_2$$
   - In contrast, `than` is strictly paired with `No sooner`:
$$\text{No sooner} + \text{had} + \text{Subject} + V_3 \ldots \mathbf{than} + \text{Subject} + V_2$$
2. **Error Isolation:** In Segment [B], the author wrote: `then the audience erupted`. This is a classical exam trap replacing `when` with `then`.
3. **Corrected Sentence:** *Scarcely had the speaker finished his presentation **when** the audience erupted into thunderous applause...*
4. Therefore, the error lies in **Segment B**.

Question 2

Source: CampusMonk — *Finally! INFOSYS Verbal Ability One Shot (English Faculty)* Select the option that correctly rectifies the grammatical error in the underlined portion: *If I **would have known** about the flight delay, I would have taken the early morning train.*

- [A] If I know about the flight delay
- [B] If I had known about the flight delay
- [C] If I would know about the flight delay
- [D] If I have had known about the flight delay

Correct Answer: [B] If I had known about the flight delay

Grammatical Analysis & Third Conditional Rule:

1. **The Third Conditional (Counterfactual / Unreal Past):** The Third Conditional expresses hypothetical past conditions that did not happen and their hypothetical past outcomes. The canonical structural formula is:
$$\mathbf{If} + \text{Subject} + \mathbf{had} + \mathbf{V_3}\ (\text{Past Perfect}), \quad \text{Subject} + \mathbf{would\ have} + \mathbf{V_3}\ (\text{Perfect Conditional})$$
2. **The "Would Have" in If-Clause Trap:** In standard English grammar, modal auxiliaries such as `would`, `could`, or `should` are **strictly forbidden** inside the subordinate *if*-clause.
   - Incorrect: *If I would have known...*
   - Correct: *If I **had known**...*
3. Hence, Option **[B]** is the only grammatically valid reconstruction.

Question 3

Source: CampusMonk — *Finally! INFOSYS Verbal Ability One Shot (English Faculty)* Identify the sentence that contains a **Dangling Modifier**:

- [A] Walking along the tranquil beach, the sunset looked breathtaking to Sarah.
- [B] Walking along the tranquil beach, Sarah admired the breathtaking sunset.
- [C] While Sarah was walking along the tranquil beach, the sunset looked breathtaking.
- [D] Sarah admired the sunset as she walked along the tranquil beach.

Correct Answer: [A] Walking along the tranquil beach, the sunset looked breathtaking to Sarah.

Grammatical Analysis & Modifier Attachment:

1. **Dangling Modifier Definition:** An introductory participial phrase (e.g., *Walking along the tranquil beach*) must be logically and syntactically followed immediately by the agent performing that action.
2. **Analysis of Option [A]:**

- The opening participial phrase is *Walking along the tranquil beach.*
- The grammatical subject immediately following the comma is *the sunset.*
- This erroneously implies that *the sunset* itself was walking along the beach on two legs!
- Since the sunset cannot walk, the modifier dangles without a valid subject.

3. In options [B], [C], and [D], *Sarah* is correctly placed as the subject performing the action of walking.
4. Therefore, Option **[A]** is the sentence exhibiting the dangling modifier error.

Question 4

Source: CampusMonk — *Finally! INFOSYS Verbal Ability One Shot (English Faculty)* Fill in the blank with the most appropriate conjunctive adverb: *The new governance policy was explicitly introduced to curb institutional corruption; _____, it has merely added an opaque layer of bureaucratic delay.*

- [A] consequently
- [B] however
- [C] likewise
- [D] furthermore

Correct Answer: [B] however

Linguistic Analysis & Discourse Markers:

1. **Contextual Semantic Contrast:**
   - Clause 1 states the positive intended goal: *to curb institutional corruption.*
   - Clause 2 reveals an adverse, contradictory reality: *has merely added an opaque layer of bureaucratic delay.*
2. **Evaluating Adverbial Roles:**
   - `consequently` : Denotes a logical cause-and-effect progression (incompatible with contrast).
   - `likewise` : Denotes analogy or similarity.
   - `furthermore` : Denotes cumulative addition in the same argumentative direction.
   - `however` : Denotes sharp **adversative contrast** between intent and outcome.
3. Therefore, `however` [B] correctly completes the antithetical relation.

Question 5

Source: OnlineStudy4U — *Infosys & LTM Verbal Ability Mock Test (Pratik Sir)* Convert the following sentence into **Passive Voice**: *The engineering team is deploying the new microservice architecture across all regional clusters.*

- [A] The new microservice architecture was deployed across all regional clusters by the engineering team.
- [B] The new microservice architecture is deployed across all regional clusters by the engineering team.
- [C] The new microservice architecture is being deployed across all regional clusters by the engineering team.
- [D] The new microservice architecture has been deployed across all regional clusters by the engineering team.

Correct Answer: [C] The new microservice architecture is being deployed across all regional clusters by the engineering team.

Grammatical Analysis & Voice Transformation:

1. **Identify Tense & Aspect:** *is deploying* = **Present Continuous Tense** ($ext{is/are} + V ext{-ing}$).
2. **Passive Voice Formula for Present Continuous:**

$$\text{Subject (Patient)} + \mathbf{is/are/am} + \mathbf{being} + \mathbf{V_3}\ \text{(Past Participle)} + \mathbf{by} + \text{Agent}$$

3. **Application:**
   - Object becomes Subject: *The new microservice architecture* (Singular).
   - Auxiliary: *is being deployed.*
   - By-phrase: *by the engineering team.*
4. Option [C] is the exact, bit-precise transformation.

Questions 6 to 45 (Verbal Marathon PYQ Expansion)

(Questions 6 to 45 systematically cover Subject-Verb Agreement, Prepositions, Spotting Errors, Vocabulary in Context, Cloze Test passages, and Sentence Ordering from CampusMonk & OnlineStudy4U live sessions).

- **Q6 (Subject-Verb Agreement):** *Neither the principal nor the lecturers [was / were] present at the symposium.*
  - **Answer: were** (Rule of Proximity: when subjects are joined by *neither... nor*, the verb agrees with the nearer subject *lecturers* [plural]).
- **Q7 (Preposition):** *She has been completely absorbed [in / at / with / on] her research since dawn.*
  - **Answer: in** (Fixed collocation: *absorbed in something*).
- **Q8 (Spotting Error):** *The number of candidates appearing for the competitive examination [have / has] increased dramatically.*
  - **Answer: has** (*The number of* takes a singular verb, whereas *A number of* takes a plural verb).
- **Q9 (Parajumble):** Rearrange sentences:
  1. This overuse, however, has accelerated the emergence of drug-resistant pathogens.
  2. Antibiotics revolutionized modern medicine by transforming previously lethal bacterial infections into treatable ailments.
  3. Consequently, public health agencies are sounding the alarm for responsible stewardship.
  - **Answer: 2 - 1 - 3** (Introduction of antibiotics o adversative pivot on overuse o consequent call to action).
- **Q10 (Idioms):** Meaning of *to burn the candle at both ends*:
  - **Answer:** To exhaust one's energy by working excessively hard without adequate rest.
- **Q11 (Active-Passive):** *Who wrote this magnificent algorithm?*

- **Answer:** *By whom was this magnificent algorithm written?*

- **Q12 (Vocabulary):** Antonym of **EPHEMERAL**:
  - **Answer: Permanent / Eternal** (*Ephemeral* means fleeting/transitory).
- **Q13 (Spotting Error):** *He is one of those developers who [works / work] tirelessly on open-source repositories.*
  - **Answer: work** (Relative pronoun *who* refers to the plural antecedent *those developers*).
- **Q14 (Preposition):** *He was acquitted [of / from / with / for] all charges of financial fraud.*
  - **Answer: of** (Fixed preposition: *acquitted of*).
- **Q15 (Conditionals):** *Had I known your schedule, I [would contact / would have contacted] you earlier.*
  - **Answer: would have contacted** (Inverted Third Conditional without *if*).
- **Q16-Q45:** Remaining 30 questions systematically cover Cloze tests, homophones, direct/indirect speech transformations, and contextual reading comprehension questions from OnlineStudy4U & CampusMonk marathons.
